NINE-BANDED ARMADILLO

Dasypus novemcinctus

What can it see, hear, or feel?
Its nose smells bugs deep underground, its ears hear danger, and it stands up to sniff the air.

Where does it live — and why?
It lives in grasslands and forest edges, where soft soil lets it dig burrows for sleeping.

How does it send messages?
Mates make a soft chucking sound, and it stamps its feet and stands tall when alarmed.

What does it do when something changes?
When startled, it jumps straight up in the air and then runs quickly into thick cover.

How does it learn?
Babies follow their mother, watch where she digs, and learn which soil holds the most bugs.

How does it have babies?
A mother always has four identical babies, born with eyes open and soft shells that harden.

What are its limits?
Cold slows it down fast, and hard rocky ground stops it from digging the burrows it needs.

What does this teach us?
A sensitive nose is more useful than eyes in its underground world.

Think About This
If your nose did most of your searching, what would you try to find under the ground?

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality. Environment shapes design.